for this, naturally it would require help which should be given by the Axis powers in the form of a loan which India, once free, would pay back.

According to Bose India is morally ripe for the revolution, what is lacking is the courage to take the first step: the great obstacles to action are on one side the lack of faith in their own capabilities and on the other the blind persuasion of British excessive power. He says that if 50,000 men, Italian, German, or Japanese could reach the frontiers of India, the Indian army would desert, the masses would uprise and the end of English domination could be achieved in a very short time.

The evolution of the Indian public opinion—according to Bose is deep in another sense also : till the beginning of the war a great part of the Indian political world was sincerely convinced that Italy, Germany and Japan were the enemies of humanity : after the start of the conflict and the fall of their hopes based on English politics, many Indians have started realising that they have been played low by England on this point.

As already mentioned—and on this point I cannot but agree with him—Bose is of the opinion that the main obstacle to the possibilities of a revolution in India is the great fear of England and more than the fear the belief that England with her strength and her luck will eventually overcome even this crisis: our recent defeats in Africa and in Greece plus the American attitude have contributed much to confirm this opinion also of those who last summer had began doubting. I have said that this is correct; it is a state of mind that I see every day in front of me in Afghanistan, where one has a more restricted view of international happenings than in India : the defeat of England is wanted and desired but there is fear to believe it.

The basic problem is therefore, according to Bose to convince the Indians with facts and with propaganda that England can be beaten and shall be beaten; once this is achieved one has already covered 70 per cent of the road.

Bose states that in the Indian political life today he is the person whose words carry most weight in foreign politics. He says that at the Tripuri meeting in which he invited the Congress to formulate a definite programme of action, I prophesied that the European war would start within six months. At the time I said that with a polemic aim only—he tells me—but chance wanted